From Alpha to Omega Excerpts

July 25, 2025 – Oct 12, 2026

Adapted readings from Prof. Anne H. Groton's *From Alpha to Omega*. Might be missing some chapters. Likely contains many errors.

Chapters 5 through 25 are adapted from Aesop's fables. From chapter 26 on, the readings become more interesting, with adapted passages from Plato, Demosthenes, and Thucydides.

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Chapter 5: A Fowl Plan Backfires

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 55

Επειδὴ ἡ δέσποινα ἀκούει τοῦ ἀλεκτρυόνος, κελεύει τὰς θεραπαίνᾶς σπεύδειν ἐκ τῶν κλῑνῶν καὶ πονεῖν. αἱ θεραπαίναι τῆς δεσποίνης οὐκ ἐθέλουσι πονεῖν· θύουσι τὸν ἀλεκτρυόνα. ἡ δέσποινα, ἐπειδη οὐκ ἀκούει τοῦ ἀλεκτρυόνος, ἀγνοεῖ τὴν ὥρᾶν καὶ ἐννυχέστερον κελεύει τὰς θεραπαίνας πονεῖν. τὸ ἴδιον βοὐλεμα τὰς θεραπαίνᾶς βλάπτει.

When the mistress hears the rooster, she orders the servants to hasten out of their beds and to work. The servants of the mistress do not wish to work; they sacrifice the rooster. The mistress, since she cannot hear the rooster, doesn't know the time and orders the servants to work earlier in the morning. Their own plan harmed the servants.

Chapter 6: Old Habits Never Die

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 50

Ἡ Ἀφροδίτη γαλῆν εἰς κόρην ἀλλάττει. τὴν κόρην νεᾱνίᾶς γαμεῖ. ἀλλ᾽ ἡ θεὰ μέλλει τῆς κόρης πειράσειν. τοὺς τρόπους τῆς γαλῆς ἔτι ἕξει ἡ κόρη· ἡ Ἀφροδίτη μῦν πέμπει εἰς τὴν οἰκίᾶν τῆς κόρης. τὸν μῦν ἡ κόρη διώκει· μὴ δίωκε, ὦ κόρη· γαλῆ οὐκέτι εἶ. ἀλλ᾽ ἡ κόρη τὸν μῦν διώκει. ἡ θεὰ τὴν κόρην εἰς γαλῆν πάλιν ἀλλάττει. οὐκ ἔχει καὶ ἡ Ἀφροδίτη ἀλλάττειν τοὺς τρόπους.

Aphrodite turns a weasel into a maiden. The maiden marries a young man. The goddess intends to test the maiden. Does the maiden still possess the habits of a weasel? Aphrodite sends a mouse into the house of the maiden. Will the maiden chase the mouse? Do not chase, maiden; you are no longer a weasel. But the maiden chases the mouse. The goddess turns the maiden into a weasel again. Not even Aphrodite could change her habits.

Chapter 7: Fleeting Joys and Fleeing Fish

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 13

Ἁλιεῖς τὴν σαγήνην ἕλκουσιν ἐν τῷ ποταμῷ. ἐπειδὴ μέλλουσι σχήσειν πολλοὺς ἰχθῦς, χαίρουσι καὶ ὀρχοῦνται. ἀλλ᾽ ἐπεὶ εἰς τὴν σαγήνην βλέπουσιν, οὐχ ὥρᾱ χαίρειν· ἔχουσι λίθους, οὐκ ἰχθῦς. οὐκέτι χαίρουσιν· οὐκέτι ὀρχοῦνται ἐν τῇ ὁδῷ. ἀλλ᾽ ἡ ἐμπειρίᾱ παιδεύσει τοὺς ἁλιεῖς. οἱ θεοὶ τοῖς ἀνθρώποις χαρὰς πέμπουσιν, ἀλλὰ καὶ λύπᾱς. ἡ λύπη ἀδελφὴ τῆς χαρᾶς ἐστιν.

The fishermen drag the net in the sea. Since they intend to have many fish, they rejoice and dance. But when they look into the net, it is not time to rejoice: they have stones, not fish. They are no longer happy: they no longer dance in the road. But the experience shall teach the fishermen. The gods send joys to men, but also griefs. Sadness is the sister of joy.

Chapter 8: The Treasure Hunt

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 42

Γεωργὸς ἄξιος μέλλει ἀπολείψειν τὸν βίον καὶ ἐθέλει τῶν τέκνων πειρᾶν. Τὸν βίον ἀπολείψω, ὦ τέκνα, ἀλλ᾽ ἐν τῇ ἀμπέλῳ εὑρήσετε θησαυρόν. χαίρετε. ἐπεὶ ὁ γεωργὸς ὁ ἀγαθὸς τὸν βίον ἀπολείπει, οἱ ἀδελφοὶ σπεύδεουσιν ἐν τῇ ἀμπέλῳ σκάπτειν. οὐκ ἔχουσιν εὑρίσκειν τὸν καλὸν θυσαυρόν, ἀλλ᾽ τῷ ἀξίῳ ἔργῳ ποιοῦσι τὰ φυτὰ τῆς ἀμπέλου καλά. τοῖς τέκνοις οὐ δῆλον τὸ ἀγαθὸν δῶρον τοῦ γεωργοῦ· τὸ ἔργον θησαυρὸς τοῖς ἀνθρώποις.

A good farmer is about to leave his life behind and wishes to test his sons. "I will leave my life behind, sons, but in the vineyard, you shall find treasure. Goodbye." After the good farmer leaves his life, the brothers hasten to dig in the vineyard. They are not able to find the beautiful treasure, but by their good work, make beautiful plants of the vineyard. The good gift of the farmer [is] clear to his sons: the work is treasure for the men.

Chapter 9: Asinine Behavior

Adapted from Aesop's Fable 190

Ονος κηπουρῷ δουλεύει. ἐπειδὴ ἐκ τοῦ πολλὰς λύπᾱς ἔχει, τοῖς ἀθανάτοις εὔχεται· Ὁ δεσπότης κακός. οὐκέτι ἐθέλω τῷ κηπουρῷ δουλεύειν. τὸν ὄνον οἱ θεοὶ κελεύουσι κεραμεῖ δουλεύειν. ἀλλὰ πάλιν, ἐπειδὴ ἔτι τῶν λῡπῶν οὐκ ἐλεύθερος ὁ ὄνος, τοῖς ἀθανάτοις εὔχεται. τὸν ὄνον οἱ θεοὶ βυρσοδέψῃ πέμπουσιν. ὁ ὄνος, ἐπειδὴ βλέπει τὸ τοῦ δεσπότου ἔργον, τοὺς προτέρους δεσπότᾱς ποθεῖ. μὴ σπεύδετε, ὦ οἰκέται, ἀλλάττειν τοὺς δεσπότᾱς.

A donkey serves a gardener. Since he has many griefs from work, he prays to the undying: "My master is evil. I no longer wish to serve the gardener." The gods order the donkey to serve a potter. But again, since the donkey is still not free of his griefs, he prays to the undying. The gods send the donkey to a tanner. The donkey, when he sees to work of his master, longs for his former masters. Do not hasten, servants, to change your masters.[1]

[1] Again, this is adapted from an old text.

Chapter 26: Healing of the Man Born Blind — Part 1

Adapted from John 9:11-17

Ὁ ἄνθροπος ὁ λεγόμενος Ἰησοῦς πηλὸν ἐποίησε καὶ ἔχρισέ μου τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς καὶ εἶπέ μοι. Νίψαι· καὶ νιψάμενος ἔβλεψα καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι εἶπον αὐτῷ, Ποῦ ἐστιν ἐκεῖνος· λέγει, Οὐκ οἶδα. ἄγουσιν αὐτὸν πρὸς τοὺς Φαρισαίους. παλίν οὖν ἠρώτων αὐτὸν καὶ οἱ Φαρισαῖοι ὅπως ἔβλεψεν. ὁ δ΄ εἶπεν αὐτοῖς, Ἐκεῖνος πηλῷ ἔχρισέ μου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς, καὶ ἐνιψάμην, καὶ βλέπω. ἔλεγον οὖν ἐκ τῶν Φαρισαίων τινές, Οὐκ ἔστιν οὗτος ὁ ἄνθρωπος παρὰ Θεοῦ, τὸ γὰρ σάββατον οὐ τηρεῖ. ἄλλοι ἔλεγον, Πῶς ἔχει ἄνθρωπος ἁμαρτωλὸς τάδε τὰ σημεῖα ποιεῖν· καὶ σχίσμα ἦν ἐν αὐτοῖς. λέγουσιν οὖν τῷ ποτε τυφλῷ πάλιν, Τί λέγεις περὶ τούτου ὃς ἀνέῳξέ σου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς· ὁ δ΄ εἶπε, Προφήτης ἐστίν.

"…The man called Jesus made mud, he both anointed my eyes and said to me, 'Wash'; and having washed, I saw. And the others said to him, "Where is this man?" He said, "I do not know." They lead him to the Pharisees. And again, then, the Pharisees asked him how he could see. And he says to them, "That man anointed my eyes with mud, and I washed, and I see. Then some of the Pharisees were saying, "Is that man a follower of God, for he does not observe the Sabbath?" Others were saying, "How is a sinful man able to create these miracles?" And division was among them. Then they say once again to the blind man, "What do you say concerning this man who opened your eyes?" And he replies, "He is a prophet."

Chapter 27: Healing of the Man Born Blind — Part 2

Adapted from John 9:19-21, 24-27

καὶ οἱ Φαρισαῖοι ἠρώτησαν αὐτοὺς λέγοντες, Οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ υἱὸς ὑμῶν ὅς τυφλὸς ἐγεννήθη· πῶς οὖν βλέπει ἄρτι· ἀπεκρίθησαν οὖν οἱ γονεῖς αὐτοῦ καὶ εἶπον, Οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ υἱός ἡμῶν ὅσ τυφλὸς ἐγεννήθη· ὅπως δὲ νῦν βλέπει οὐκ ἴσμεν, ἢ ὅστις ἀνέῳξεν αὐτοῦ τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἴσμεν. αὐτὸν ἐρωτήσατε, ἡλικίᾱν γὰρ ἔχει· αὐτὸς περὶ ἑαυτοῦ ἀποκρινεῖται.

And the Pharisees asked them [the parents of the blind man], saying, 'is this man your son who was born blind? How then does he see now?' Then the parents answered to them and said, 'This is our son who was born blind: we do not know how he sees now, nor do we know who has opened the eyes of our son. Ask him, for he is of age: he answers for himself.'

ἐκάλεσαν οὖν οἱ Φαρισαῖοι τὸν ἄνθρωπον πάλιν, καὶ εἶπον αὐτῷ, Δόξα τῷ Θεῷ. ἡμεῖς ἴσμεν τὴν ἀλήθειαν· ὁ Ιησοῦς ἁμαρτωλός ἐστιν. ἀπεκρίθη οὖν ἐκεῖνος αὐτοῖς, Οὐκ οἶδα εἰ ἁμαρτωλός ἐστιν, ἀλλὰ τόδ΄ οἶδα· τυφλὸς πόλλ΄ ἔτη ὢν ἄρτι βλέπω. ἠρώτησαν οὖν αὐτόν, Πῶς ἀνεῴχθησάν σου οἱ ὀφθαλμοί· ἀπεκρίθη αὐτοῖς, Εἶπον ὑμῖν ἤδη καὶ οὐκ ἠκούσατε· τί πάλιν ἐθέλετε ἀκούειν· μὴ καὶ ὑμεῖς ἐθέλετε αὐτοῦ μαθεταὶ γενέσθαι·

Then the Pharisees ordered the man again, and said to him, 'Opinion to God. We know our truth: Jesus is sinful. Then the aforementioned man answered them, 'I do not see whether he is sinful, but I know this: being blind for many years, I see now.' Then they asked him, 'How were your eyes opened?' He answered them, 'I already said to you and you did not listen: why do you wish to hear again? Do you wish to become his disciples?'

Chapter 28: Healing of the Man Born Blind — Part 3

Adapted from John 9:28-39

καὶ ἐλοιδόρησαν αὐτὸν λέγοντες, Σὺ μαθητὴς εἶ ἐκείνου, ἡμεῖς δὲ τοῦ Μωϋσέως ἐσμὲν μαθηταί. τὸν Ἰησοῦν οὐκ ἴσμεν ὁπόθεν ἐστίν. ἀπεκρίθη ὁ ἄνθρωπος, Θαυμάζω ὅτι οὐκ ἴστε ὁπόθεν ἔστίν. ἴσμεν γὰρ τόδ΄· οἱ ἁμαρτωλοὶ οὔποτ΄ ἀκουσθήσονται ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἀλλ΄ ὁ θεσεβὴς ἀκουσθήσεται. τίς ἐκ τοῦ αἰῶνος ἀνέῳχε τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τυφλοῦ γεγεννημένου· ὅς ἔχει τοῦτο ποιεῖν, οὗτος οὐκοῦν ἐστι παρὰ τοῦ Θεοῦ· ἀπεκρίθησαν αὐτῷ, Ἐν ἁμαρτίαις σὺ ἐγεννήθης. διδαχθησόμεθα ὑπὸ σοῦ· καὶ ἐξέβαλον αὐτόν.

And they [the Pharisees] reproached him, saying, 'You are a disciple of that man, and we are disciples of Moses. We do not know from where Jesus is.' The man answered, 'I am surprised that you do not know from where he is. For we know this: the sinful shall never be heard by God, but the pious shall be heard. From the dawn of age, why has he opened the eyes of a man having been born blind? Who is able to do this, is this man not a son of God?' To this they replied, 'You were born in sins. Shall we be lectured by you?' And they threw him out.

ὁ δ΄ Ἰησοῦς εὑρὼν αὐτὸν εἶπε, Σὺ πιστεύεις εἰς τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ ἀνθρώπου· ἀπεκρίθη ἐκεῖνος. Τίς ἐστι, Κύριε· εἶπεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς, Καὶ ἑώρᾱκας αὐτόν. καὶ ὁ λέγων μετὰ σοῦ ἐκεῖνός ἐστιν. ὁ δ΄ εἶπε, Πιστεύω, Κύριε· καὶ προσεκύνησεν αὐτῷ. καὶ εἶπεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς, Εἰς κρῖμα ἐγὼ εἰς τὸν κόσμον τοῦτον ἦλθον· οἱ μὲν οὐ βλέποντες βλέψονται, οἱ δὲ βλέποντες τυφλοὶ γενήσονται.

Then Jesus, finding the man, said, 'Do you believe in the Son of man?' The aforementioned man replied, 'Who is he, Lord?' Jesus said, 'And you have seen him, and the one speaking with you is him.' Then he said, 'I believe, Lord,' and worshipped him. And Jesus said, 'For judgement I came into this world: Some who do not see shall see for themselves, others who see shall become blind.'

Chapter 29: Athens Reacts to Bad News — Part 1

Adapted from Demosthenes' *De Corona* 168-169

ὁ δὲ Φίλιππος ἔχων τὴν δύναμιν τὴν Ἐλάτειαν κατέλαβεν. ἀλλὰ τὸν τότε συμβάντα ἐν τῇ πόλει θόρυβον ἴστε μὲν πάντες, μῑκρὰ δ᾽ ἀκούσατε ὅμως αὐτὰ τὰ ἀναγκαιότατα.

ἑσπέρᾱ μὲν γὰρ ἦν, ἦλθε δ᾽ ἀγγέλλων τις πρὸς τοὺς πρυτάνεις, Ἐλάτεια κατείληπται. καὶ μετὰ ταῦθ᾽ οἱ μέν, εὐθὺς τὸ δεῖπνον λείποντες, τοὺς ἐκ τῶν σκηνῶν τῶν κατὰ τὴν ἀγορὰν ἐξεῖργον, οἱ δὲ τοὺς στρατηγοὺς μετεπέμποντο καὶ τὸν σαλπιγκτὴν ἐκάλουν καὶ θορύβου πλήρης ἦν ἡ πόλις.

τῇ δ᾽ ὑστεραίᾳ ἡμέρᾳ οἱ πρυτάνεις τὴν βουλὴν ἐκάλουν εἰς τὸ βουλευτήριον, ὑμεῖς δ᾽ εἰς τὴν ἐκκλησίᾱν ἐτρέπεσθε.

And Philip[2], holding troops, seized Elatea[3]. All of you remember the chaos having happened in the city, but nevertheless, for a little while listen to the most necessary details.

For it was evening, someone came to the prytaneis[4], announcing that Elatea had been seized. And after this they, immediately abandoning supper, drove out the vendors operating out of tents throughout the marketplace, summoned the generals, and were calling the trumpeter, and the city was full of chaos.

On the following evening the prytaneis were calling a council in the council-chamber, and they turned themselves towards the assembly.

[2] Philipp II of Macedonia

[3] Town in central Greece

[4] πρύτανις, -εως, ὁ : one of the 50 chosen by lot to run Athens for a month

Chapter 30: Athens Reacts to Bad News — Part 2

Adapted from Demosthenes' *De Corona* 170-173

καὶ ἀπήγγειλαν οἱ πρυτάνεις τὰ προσηγγελμένα ἑαυτοῖς. ἠρώτᾱ μὲν ὁ κήρυξ, Τίς ἀγορεύειν βούλεται· ἀνίστατο δ᾽ οὐδείς. πολλάκις δὲ τοῦ κήρῡκος ἐρωτῶντος, ἀνίστατο δ᾽ οὐδείς, πάντων μὲν τῶν στρατηγῶν παρόντων, πάντων δὲ τῶν ῥητόρων, καλούσης δὲ τῆς κοινῆς τῆς πατρίδος φωνῆς τὸν ἐροῦντα ὑπὲρ σωτηρίᾱς· ἡ γὰρ φωνὴ τοῦ κήρῡκος νομίζεται εἶναι φωνὴ κοινὴ τῆς πατρίδος.

ἀλλ᾽ ἐκεῖνος ὁ καιρὸς καὶ ἡ ἡμέρᾱ ἐκείνη οὐ μόνον εὔνουν καὶ πλούσιον ἄνδρα ἐκάλει, ἀλλὰ καὶ παρηκολουτηκότα τοῖς πράγμασιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς, καὶ συλλελογισμένον ὀρθῶς τίνος χάριν ταῦτ᾽ ἔπρᾱττεν ὁ Φίλιππος καὶ τί βουλόμενος.

ἐφάνην οὖν οὗτος ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ ἐγώ, καὶ παρελθὼν εἶπον εἰς ὑμᾶς.